

First Braille SmartPhone

The smartphone allows those with visual impairments to touch the real-time image of a friend's face

**New netgear router**

Netgear is set to come up with its new 802.11ac WiFi hardware that is estimated to have a 60 per cent increase in speed

Careers in Software Testing

Testers with domain-specific knowledge and technical skills are paid more than developers. Interested?

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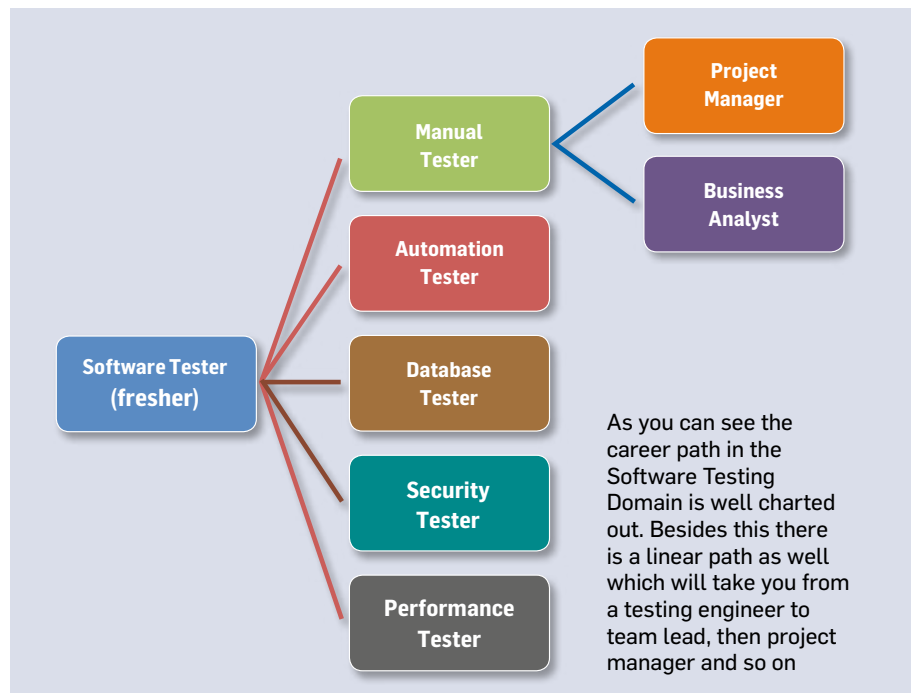
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There was a time when Software Testing was considered a layman's job with no required domain or technical skills. Anyone with basic knowledge of computers could be employed as a Tester. The work allocation for testers was also very limited.

The job has gained significance over time, and the testing team is now involved in the complete end-to-end process, beginning from the initial requirement reviews right until the testing of the final software. Testers with domain-specific knowledge and technical skills are in demand, paid more than our favourite developers, and those with remarkable skills are climbing the corporate ladder faster as well. Testing skills in niche areas such as SOA (Service-oriented architecture) testing, mobile-based testing, security testing and database-oriented testing are in top demand.

There was a time when a ratio of 1:10 prevailed in the industry where one tester was hired for every 10 developers. Now, however, the ratio is 1:4 or even 1:2 depending upon the criticality of the project; for instance a banking or insurance project.

Software Testing, also known as Quality Assurance Analysis, involves checking for bugs in software. Being a software tester, you need to be analytical, open-minded, creative, detail-oriented, passionate, patient and a good listener. Tamanna Bedi, QA Manager at Graycell Technology Exports commented, "Software testing is a gold mine for the people who like to learn new



stuff and want to dig down deep into the code. The industry looks for dynamic individuals who can possess the skill of finding bugs and can give innovative solution for the same."

Why Software Testing?

If you're sitting on the fence unable to decide whether this is the career for you, here are a few motivations for getting into software testing:

Good Packages and Returns: Equal or better packages are being offered to QA Analysts (Quality Assurance) these days in comparison to their developer peers. The reason for this is the varied kinds of projects in the market where primary focus is not on development but on maintenance and performance. The other reason is data security which is the main concern for every client right now. Automation testers, performance testers, database testers and security testers are paid generously in the industry.

Ample Onsite Opportunities: Clients like having the confidence that the software they've paid for actually works. Therefore, they always need more testers on-site than developers to test their software thoroughly. Secondly, as testing is a short-term activity covering staged deliveries, bug fixing, re-testing, UAT etc. it's easy to compensate. Testing done on-site also makes communication easier as there might be tests which require interaction with other technical groups and business experts usually present at on-site offices. And on-site locations might be exotic too.

Lucrative Alternate Career: If you decide to take up the profile of a tester and should you decide this is not the line for you, there's another lucrative role waiting in the wings for you – that of a Business Analyst or BA. The reason for this obvious career progression is the tester/QA Analyst's involvement in the end-to-end business process. For instance, during the